COURTING DISTINCTION

The institute is gearing up its students with knowledge of new-age tools like Gen AI to prepare them for the legal battles of the future

BY AJAY SUKUMARAN



HEMANT MISHRA

The verdant campus of the National Law School of India University (NLSIU) in Bengaluru has had a makeover in the past year. A new amphitheatre has come up next to the library block while landscaped ponds have been built into some of the open spaces on the campus, to give students more space for interaction. Meanwhile, the main walkway has been redesigned with tactile paving to assist the vision-impaired. At India's premier law institute, where inclusivity and diversity are guiding principles, the infrastructure facelift is in tandem with its academic growth phase.

In 2024, the institute will welcome 300 students in its flagship BA LLB course, 120 in the three-year LLB programme and a like number in the LLM course, taking the total headcount across batches to around 1,300, says Vice Chancellor Sudhir Krishnaswamy. To keep pace with the growing student population, NLSIU has increased its faculty strength. "Starting July 2024, we will touch (a headcount of) 100 in faculty, and we will go all the way to 125," he says. This will help maintain a teacher-student ratio of roughly 1:15.

In academics, a big area of change over the past 12-18 months has been in Generative Artificial Intelligence, or Gen AI. "Law is one of those professions that is likely to be deeply disrupted by the emergence of Gen AI. For us, as a law university, that means at least three things," says Krishnaswamy. "First, we get our students to become expert users and familiar with these new tools but, much more than that, in a cur-

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"We coach our students to ask why the law is as it is. And we coach our students to ask what the law should be. We graduate students who are creative thinkers with very strong academic foundations"

PROFESSOR SUDHIR KRISHNASWAMY
Vice Chancellor, NLSIU